Colour for your website and business

Yes, above all where you sell purity, precision and a modern impression. Silver promises calm, but it can easily seem cold.

In business silver is a colour that **invites trust in precision**, but it also carries the label of distance. It can seem modern, technical, elegant and luxurious. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into a logo, a website or an advertisement.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create **a striking impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Silver can say, for example

"It is precise." "It is modern." "It is clean." "It is calm."

- **Elegance and craft.** Silver is often used for cutlery, jewellery and design.
- **Technology.** Metal, stainless steel and silver belong to technology. Too much, however, can feel sterile.
- **Prestige.** Second place, a medal, cards. Silver here tends to be a step below gold.
- **Coldness.** Without a warm companion it can seem aloof.
- **Mirror.** A gleam catches the eye. It must not dazzle.

Depending on the shade, though, it also acts differently. Pearl is **delicate and modern**, steel **firm and technical**, oxidised **traditional and earthy**.

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Simple tips

Add warmth
Wood, photographs of people or a gentle colour companion. Pure silver alone tends to be cold.

Show the product
A silver package on a silver background disappears. Give it contrast.

Shade by role
Steel for technology, pearl for delicacy, oxidised for tradition.

Legibility
Silver text on a light background is hard to read. Watch the size and contrast.

A human face
Precision does not have to stand in the doorway with arms folded. Add clear language.

Colour blindness
About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Dark text on a light background is the safest choice for most people.

Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell precision, purity or a modern impression, silver can help you.

Jewellery, cutlery and design

Silver here belongs to both material and colour. Make sure the shine does not say more than the product itself.

Technology and vehicles

Metal and silver here give an impression of a new era. Make sure it does not seem sterile.

Clinical and laboratory settings

Silver can support an impression of cleanliness and precision. Add personal touches so the place does not recall a factory.

Fashion and art

Silver suits an evening, a campaign and a stage. Wood and a gentle companion calm it down.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Care for people.** Too much coldness can seem unapproachable.
- **Playful and light services.** For services promising lightness and play, silver can create different expectations.
- **Clinics and counselling.** Coldness can clash with confidentiality.
- **Long texts on a website.** Silver text on a light background is tiring.
- **Product presentations.** A silver filter can distort the real colours.

Most important is not whether a design looks expensive. It is whether a person understands where they have come and what they can expect.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the silver?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that silver means a modern style.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know silver from cutlery, jewellery and racing cars. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

Rolls-Royce Silver Ghost (cars)
In 1907 Claude Johnson had a demonstration car made for Rolls-Royce, painted in aluminium paint, with silver-plated fittings. The name Silver Ghost was meant to stress its almost silent running.

Georg Jensen (silversmithing)
The Danish silversmith Georg Jensen opened his own workshop in Copenhagen in 1904. His Art Nouveau designs often used organic shapes and precious stones such as amber or opal.

Christofle (cutlery)
The brand was founded in Paris in 1830 by Charles Christofle. In 1842 he obtained patents for electroplated gilding and silvering, bringing silver plating to France.

Mercedes-Benz (cars)
The Mercedes teams are nicknamed the Silver Arrows, in German Silberpfeile. In the 1930s, together with Auto Union, they dominated racing. The nickname has stayed to this day.

What they share is that silver carries a simple message. **Precision and distance.** And it mostly does not outweigh what is around it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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